

THE GREAT ZIMBABWE STATE.

- The Great Zimbabwe state was one of the late Iron Age states in pre-colonial Zimbabwe.
- The founder of this state is unknown but the state existed after the fall of another state known as the Mapungubwe state.
- It is believed that this state existed between 1200AD and 1500AD and was located in present day Masvingo in Zimbabwe.
- The name "Great Zimbabwe" which means house of stones was derived from stone walls which were found in the state.
- The state was inhabited by Shona speaking people.

Reasons for the rise of Great Zimbabwe / Factors which led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe

Political reasons for the rise of Great Zimbabwe state

1. A strong army led to the rise of this state.

- The Great Zimbabwe state rose because of the powerful army which was used to defend the state and to conquer some small groups into the state.

2. The decline of Mapungubwe state

- This led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state in the sense that the same people who used to stay in the Mapungubwe state started to move into the Great Zimbabwe state where there were favourable conditions for both human beings and domestic animals.

3. Peace and stability led to its rise.

- It is believed that there was general peace in the Great Zimbabwe state which led to its rise in the sense that people wanted to live in a peaceful area hence people began to move into the Great Zimbabwe area where there was peace.

4. Presence of a hilltop.

- The Great Zimbabwe state was located in an area with a hill top and this hilltop was probably chosen for defence against enemies and as a centre for religious worship and ceremonies.

5. The rise of ambitious leaders.

- The rise of ambitious leaders who wanted to create their own states led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state in the sense that these ambitious leaders wanted to control trade routes, resources and to collect tribute from their subjects

6. The place was suitable for taking refuge in war time.

- The Great Zimbabwe also rose because of the presence of Nemamwa Hill which was suitable for taking refuge in times of war hence people chose to settle in this area.

7. Control of religion by rulers led to its rise.

- The rulers of Great Zimbabwe controlled religion and they were regarded as divinely appointed hence commanded universal respect leading to the rise of the Great Zimbabwe state.

Economic reasons for the rise of Great Zimbabwe

1. Availability of fertile soil.

- There was availability of fertile soils in the area around Great Zimbabwe which promoted crop cultivation hence a lot of people chose to stay in this state.

2. Availability of greener pastures.

- There was availability of good pastures or grazing areas which promoted livestock production [pastoralism] and this led to its rise.

3. Availability of minerals.

- There were a lot of minerals like gold and iron in the Great Zimbabwe state and these minerals were suitable for trade and iron for tool making hence this led to its rise.

4. Availability of wild animals.

- There was availability of hunting grounds and wild animals for meat, skins and ivory in the area and this led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state since people wanted to hunt these animals.

5. Favourable Climate.

- The Great Zimbabwe state had favourable climate, that is, good rainfall and favourable temperatures which made people to choose to stay in this area.

6. Availability of water.

- Availability of water from nearby rivers such as Mutirikwi led to its rise because it promoted agriculture and also this water was needed for domestic uses.

7. Accessibility of the area to trade.

- The area was accessible to international trade with the Swahili, Arabs, and Persians and Chinese hence people chose to stay in this state for easy accessibility to foreign traders.

8. Availability of wild fruits.

- The area was full of wild fruits hence people preferred to stay in Great Zimbabwe state so that they would gather these fruits for food.

Social factors which led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe

1. The practice of polygamy

- The Great Zimbabwe people practiced polygamy which resulted in high population hence the rise of the Great Zimbabwe state. Polygamy also ensured adequate labour supply and soldiers and this led to its rise.

2. The practice of cattle loaning system [kuronzera]

- This system helped to unify people and made the leaders strong and it also attracted many people to come under their control.

3. The increase in population led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe.

- Increase in population in the Great Zimbabwe led to the rise of this state in the sense that people were now able to live and work together as a state under one King.

4. The role of religion.

- Religion led to the rise of the Great Zimbabwe State in the sense that people believed that Kings were divinely appointed hence this helped kings to establish a state without being opposed. Religion also helped in unifying people within the state.

5. Presence of Nemamwa Hill

- The hill was regarded as sacred for religious purposes hence this led to the rise of the Great Zimbabwe state in the sense that the people used this hill to carry out their religious activities and ceremonies.

6. Availability of granite rocks.

- Availability of granite rocks enabled people to build the stone walls thereby leading to the rise of the Great Zimbabwe state.

How important were political factors in the rise of Great Zimbabwe state? OR

To what extent did political factors contribute to the rise of the Great Zimbabwe State?

Importance of political factors/Contribution of political factors.

- ❖ Emergence of ambitious leaders who were able to establish a powerful state
- ❖ Control of religion by the rulers who were regarded as divinely appointed hence commanded universal respect.
- ❖ The desire to collect tribute by rulers led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state
- ❖ A strong army led to its rise because the army was used to maintain order and control the state.
- ❖ The fall of Mapungubwe state led to its rise as the Mapungubwe people began to move into Great Zimbabwe state.

- ❖ Unity among people led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe as unity attracted a lot of people from outside.
- ❖ Suitability of the area for defence in times of war led to its rise because of the Nemamwa Hill which was suitable for taking refuge in times of war.

However, to a lesser extent there were other factors which also led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state such as:

- Accessibility of the area to international trade whereby Great Zimbabwe state was accessible to foreign trade which made people to settle in this state.
- Availability to fertile soils which promoted crop cultivation by the people
- Abundance of pastures which were greatly required by those who kept domestic animals
- Abundance of minerals which were used by people for various purposes such as trade and paying tribute.

To what extent did the economic factors contribute to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state?

Contribution of economic factors

- Availability of fertile soil which attracted people to come and grow their crops.
- Availability of minerals promoted trade, tool making and the manufacture of weapons also led to its rise.
- -Accessibility to international trade whereby Great Zimbabwe state was accessible to foreign trade which made people to settle in this state.
- -Availability to fertile soils which promoted crop cultivation by the people
- -Availability of pastures which were greatly required by those who kept domestic animals
- -Availability of minerals which were used by people for various purposes such as trade and paying tribute.

Other factors which also led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe

- Emergence of ambitious leaders who were able to establish a powerful state
- Control of religion by the rulers who were regarded as divinely appointed hence commanded universal respect.
- The desire to collect tribute by rulers led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state
- A strong army led to its rise because the army was used to maintain order and control the state.

- The fall of Mapungubwe state led to its rise as the Mapungubwe people began to move into Great Zimbabwe state.
- Unity among people led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe as unity attracted a lot of people from outside.
- Suitability of the area for defence in times of war led to its rise because of the Nemamwa Hill which was suitable for taking refuge in times of war.

Importance of social factors in the rise of Great Zimbabwe State.

- The practice of polygamy led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe since it enabled the state to grow
- The availability of granite rocks led to its rise because these rocks were used for the construction of people's homes.
- The presence of Nemamwa Hill led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe in the sense that this Hill was regarded as sacred for religious purposes.
- Religion also led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe as people believed that the king was divinely appointed hence they respected him
- Peace and unity also led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe since people favoured to live in a peaceful area.

However, there were other factors which also led to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state such as:

- Successful agriculture led to the availability of food to the rise of Great Zimbabwe state.
- The larger herds of cattle were used by dominant lineages in the creation of a strong state.
- Availability of minerals promoted trade, tool making and the manufacture of weapons also led to its rise.
- -Accessibility to international trade whereby Great Zimbabwe state was accessible to foreign trade which made people to settle in this state.
- -Availability to fertile soils which promoted crop cultivation by the people
- -Abundance of pastures which were greatly required by those who kept domestic animals

The Construction [Building] of Great Zimbabwe

- Great Zimbabwe was built by the Shona people.
- It was built between 1100 AD and 1450 AD.
- Granite rocks were used to build Great Zimbabwe.
- The rocks were heated, cooled and split.
- They were shaped into blocks.
- No mortar was used.
- The king is believed to be the one who chose the site for Great Zimbabwe.
- The walls were thick at the base and narrower at the top.
- Slave labour was possibly used.
- The site consists of many areas such as the conical tower and the residence of the king.
- The king is the one who organized people to work with the assistance of the chiefs and the army.
- The king provided food to the people who were working.

Reasons for building Great Zimbabwe / Function / Purpose of Great Zimbabwe

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|
| ❖ As a symbol of power | -As a religious centre |
| ❖ For privacy | -As an enclosure for animals |
| ❖ For prestige | -As an administrative centre |
| ❖ As a living place for nobles | -As a fortress in times of war |
| ❖ -To show unity of the people | |
| ❖ As a centre of trade | -As a storage for grain and minerals |
| ❖ For receiving visitors | - for tribute collection |
| ❖ As a cultural centre | - as an expression of art |
| ❖ As a capital | -To spot enemies |
| ❖ As the mambos' court / headquarters [Muzindawamambo] | |

Importance of the king in the construction of Great Zimbabwe

- The king is the one who led the construction of Great Zimbabwe monuments.
- He is the one who organised labour and builders who built it.
- The king also mobilized people with the help of the army and the chiefs.
- He is the one who chose the site for the construction.
- The king was responsible for payment of builders and provision of food

Other factors important in the construction of Great Zimbabwe

- ❖ The builders who built the monuments were also important

- ❖ Vassal chiefs who helped the King to mobilize people to work
- ❖ The people who provided labour for example supplying the granite rocks
- ❖ Availability of granite rocks which were used to construct the monument.
- ❖ Masons [people who shaped stones] were also important

Economic Organization /Economic Activities of Great Zimbabwe people.

1. **Crop production.** They grew different types of crops like sorghum, millet, rapoko and pumpkins. These crops were grown for various purposes such as food, barter trade, payment of tribute and payment of lobola.
2. **Animal rearing/Pastoralism.** They kept domestic animals like cattle, goats and sheep for meat, skins and milk. Cattle were also used for paying lobola and they were a symbol of wealth.
3. **Mining.** They mined minerals like iron, gold, copper, tin, lead and silver. These minerals were used for various purposes such as payment of tribute, making tools and for trade purposes.
4. **Trading.** They practiced both internal and external trade. Externally they traded with the Swahili, Arabs and Portuguese. They imported ceramics, jewellery, beads, knives, cloth, cowry shells and guns. Internally, they traded amongst themselves using local items (barter trade)
5. **Tribute payment.** The subjects paid tribute to the king in form of gold, ivory, hoes, spears, grain, animal skins, livestock, baskets and labour. Tribute was paid as a sign of showing loyalty to the King.
6. **Hunting.** They hunted animals like hares and kudus for meat, elephants and rhinoceros for ivory and cheetahs and leopards for their precious skins.
7. **Fishing.** They caught fish to supplement their diet. Fishing was usually done by men and they mainly used iron fish hooks as well as other methods.
8. **Gathering.** This was usually done by women and young girls and they gathered fruits, vegetables and mushrooms among other things.
9. **Raiding.** They raided other states for grain, cattle, goats, women and boys. Usually the army was used to raid especially in times of drought.
10. **Blacksmithing.** This is whereby men used iron to produce various iron tools such as iron hoes, iron knives, iron axes and iron spears. These tools made their work easier as they were fast, light and efficient.

11. Pottery - this was usually done by women and they used clay soil to produce clay pots which they used for cooking and storing food.

12. Weaving - they used different items such as fibre and reeds to produce different items such as sleeping mats and hats. These items were used for domestic use and for barter trade.

How did the people benefit from these economic activities?

Benefits.

- They benefited meat from both animal rearing and hunting
- They benefited food from gathering and crop cultivation
- They benefited tools to use through blacksmithing
- They benefited minerals to trade with and to pay tribute with through mining.
- They benefited animal skins to wear through animal rearing and hunting.
- They benefited ivory to trade with through hunting.
- They benefited foreign items through external trade.

However, there are some non-benefits for example

- ❖ Mining caused land degradation and it later caused exhaustion of minerals
- ❖ Trading with foreigners led to exhaustion of some trade items such as minerals and ivory.
- ❖ Crop cultivation later led to soil infertility
- ❖ Animal rearing later led to overgrazing and shortage of grazing areas.

Uses [Importance] of cattle in the Great Zimbabwe State

- | | |
|--|-------------------------------|
| ❖ Payment of lobola [bride price] | -Symbol of wealth |
| ❖ Loaning- for political influence | -For trade |
| ❖ Payment of tribute | -For ritual ceremonies |
| ❖ For food: milk, meat and fat | -For transport |
| ❖ For skins [mats, clothes and blankets] | |
| ❖ For making drums | -Provision of manure |
| ❖ Cow dung applied on floors | -Draught power |
| ❖ For sacrifices. | -for paying avenging spirits. |
| ❖ They got straps from skins. | |
| ❖ Payment of fines | |

Describe any six uses of cattle in the Great Zimbabwe state.

1. Payment of lobola.

- The Great Zimbabwe people used cattle to pay the bride price to the bride's parents. It was their custom that a person was married using cattle.

2. Payment of fines

- Usually, the leaders would demand people to pay fines using cattle. Cases which usually demanded cattle as fines are failure to pay tribute, practicing witchcraft and taking someone's wife.

3. Slaughtered during some important ceremonies.

- These people used to slaughter cattle during some important ceremonies such as nhimbe, rain making ceremonies and funerals.

4. Paying avenging spirits (Ngozi)

- Cattle were usually used in the payment of avenging spirits whereby if someone kills a person, the spirit of that dead person would demand some cattle as compensation.

5. For food.

- Cattle were also used as source of food whereby they provided meat and milk to these people. They were however rarely slaughtered.

6. For loaning.

- Those who had a lot of cattle would loan some of their cattle to those without as a way of helping each other and strengthening their relationships. The king would also loan some of his cattle to his subjects.

7. They were used as a symbol of wealth

- Wealth was measured according to the number of cattle which a person possessed hence people kept cattle as a way of showing that they are rich.

Crafts practiced by the people of Great Zimbabwe

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------------|
| ❖ Pottery | -Basketry |
| ❖ Weaving | -Blacksmithing |
| ❖ Stone carving | -Wood carving |
| ❖ Leather work | -Making Jewellery |
| ❖ Drum making | -Building in stone |

Local items used to pay tribute in the Great Zimbabwe state.

- ❖ Iron axes
- ❖ Diamonds

- ❖ Cattle
- ❖ Sheep
- ❖ Goats
- ❖ Iron spears
- ❖ Shields
- ❖ Ivory
- ❖ Rapoko
- ❖ Millet.

How important was tribute in the Great Zimbabwe State.

- It helped to increase the wealth of the king
- It made the king highly respected and very powerful in the state.
- It showed loyalty of the people to their King.
- It prevented the chiefs from becoming more powerful than the king which will make them challenge the king.
- Items collected through tribute would be redistributed in times of famine

However, tribute had some non-benefits such as:

- ❖ It promoted corruption as some precious items such as minerals were not delivered to the King by the chiefs.
- ❖ At times people were forced to pay even if they didn't have the required items.
- ❖ It made some people to be poor as they used their important items to pay tribute with.
- ❖ Those who refused to pay tribute were severely punished.

Importance of trade in the political system of Great Zimbabwe

- It made the King to increase his wealth
- Trade made the King to be very powerful in the state because he controlled trade.
- It enabled people to pay tribute to the king with different items.
- Trade brought peace and political stability in the state.

Other factors important in the political system of Great Zimbabwe

- A strong army which defended the whole state
- Lesser chiefs who controlled provinces were also important.
- Religion which unified people
- The King was very important because he controlled the whole state.

Artefacts [man made remains] discovered at Great Zimbabwe

Chinese stone wares / porcelain / dishes	-A copper box
Glass beads	-Persian bowls
□ Mirrors	-Iron gongs
□ Soapstone bowls	-Bangles
□ Anklets	-Near Eastern glasses
□ Copper rings	-Iron spoon
□ Iron lamp holder	-Copper chains
□ -Figurines	-Candles
□ Soapstone bird	-Ceramics [pots]
□ Brass wire	-Iron wire
□ Sea shells	

Social Organisation of Great Zimbabwe.

- The society was patrilineal.
 - Ownership of cattle was a status symbol.
 - The practiced polygamy.
 - There was sexual division of labour.
 - They practised kuronzera [loaning of cattle].
 - They paid lobola to their in-laws in form of cattle.
 - They celebrated the birth of a new child.
 - They celebrated the coming of a new daughter-in-law.
 - They practiced the nhimbe system.
 - Incest and bestiality were taboos.
 - They believed in God, Mwari [Musikavanhu].
 - They believed in spirit mediums [Masvikiro] and ancestral spirits.
 - They also believed in national spirit mediums [Mhondoro].
 - The king was believed to be chosen by spirit mediums.
 - They practiced ceremonies like rain making ceremonies [Mukwerera / Mutoro].
 - The king led at all religious ceremonies of national importance.
 - They believed that spirits lived in pools and thick forests.
 - They believed in witchcraft.
 - They consulted traditional healers (N'anga)

Describe any six social activities of the Great Zimbabwe people.

1. They practiced rainmaking ceremonies.

- The Great Zimbabwe people practiced rainmaking ceremonies towards the start of the rain season to ask for the rains from their ancestors. The King is the one who presided over this ceremony.

2. Payment of lobola.

- The son - in-law paid lobola to the bride's parents to show appreciation and respect.

They usually paid lobola in form of cattle among other items.

3. They practiced polygamy.

- This is whereby men married more than one wife as a way of boosting population.

Usually, those men who were rich used their wealth to marry many wives.

4. They practiced cattle loaning system.

- Those with a lot of cattle loaned some of their cattle to those without as a way of helping them. This helped in promoting unity.

5. They consulted n'angas (traditional healers)

- These people believed in traditional healers whom they consulted especially in times of misfortunes or trouble. They would also consult n'angas in the cases of witchcraft and other cases.

6. They practiced nhimbe system

- Usually, they cooperated and work together to grow crops. The owner of the field is the one who would provide food for people to eat.

7. They did Zunde ramambo ceremony.

- This is whereby the King would ask his subjects to come and work in his fields. The king is the one who provided food for people to eat.

8. They celebrated the coming of a daughter-in-law.

- If a person married, the relatives of the boy would gather and celebrate the coming of a new daughter-in-law. These relatives would give various gifts to the daughter in law.

Benefits of these social activities

- The practice of polygamy helped to boost the population and reduce labour shortages
- Cattle loaning system promoted peace and cooperation among people

- Rainmaking ceremonies helped to provide adequate rainfall for crop cultivation and animal rearing.
- Nhimbe system also made people to have cooperation as they helped each other.
- Consulting traditional leaders helped them to chase some misfortunes and prevent witchcraft.
- Beliefs in avenging spirits helped them to respect human life.

However,

- Polygamy led to overpopulation which led to scarcity of resources.
- Cattle loaning system was sometimes a source of conflict in the event that the cattle die or get stolen
- Payment of lobola was also a source of conflict and it made men to oppress women.
- The King forced his subjects to come and work for him in his fields.

Importance of religion in the political system of Great Zimbabwe

- ❖ Religion unified people as they did religious ceremonies together.
- ❖ Rain making ceremonies brought people together as they got a chance to interact.
- ❖ The common belief in God unified people because there were no religious conflicts.
- ❖ The king commanded universal respect since his position was a divine one.
- ❖ Spirit mediums appointed the kings hence the people respected the king
- ❖ Spirit mediums stayed at the royal court providing advice and guidance to the king meaning that the King ruled in favour of the people.

Other factors important in the political system of Great Zimbabwe

- ❖ A strong economy ensured stability and better living standards.
- ❖ A strong army for maintaining law and order and defending the state against external attacks.
- ❖ Tribute made the king wealthy and he distributed part of it to ordinary people.
- ❖ Cattle loaning ensured increased support for the king.

Political Organization of Great Zimbabwe

- The king was the head of the state.
- Kingship was hereditary.
- The king was the commander in chief of the army.
- The king was the judicial leader.

- The king was the chief judge.
- The king led at all religious ceremonies.
- The king was the chief distributor of land.
- The king was helped to rule by a council of elders called Dare in Shona.
- The districts were under district chiefs.
- Provinces were under provincial chiefs.
- The chiefs were appointed by the king.
- The posts of chiefs were hereditary.
- Subjects paid tribute to the king to show loyalty.
- They raided other states for grain, cattle and the like.
- There were also important officials apart from the king in the state such as the Queen mother, King's sons in law, army commanders, spirit mediums, royal doctor, district and provincial chiefs.

Importance of tribute in the political system of Great Zimbabwe

- Payment of tribute ensured loyalty of lesser chiefs to the king.
- Tribute payment made sure that lesser chiefs would not become too rich, powerful and ambitious.
- Tribute increased the wealth, power and influence of the king.
- Items collected through tribute were redistributed by the king during times of hunger

Other factors important in the political system of Great Zimbabwe

- Religion which unified people
- Spirit mediums which chose the king
- The army which defended the state, maintained law and order, discouraged revolts and collected tribute

Social groups within the Great Zimbabwe state

- | | |
|------------------|------------------------|
| ❖ Farmers | -Soldiers |
| ❖ Stone masons | -Miners |
| ❖ Potters | -Gatherers |
| ❖ Traders | -Herbalists |
| ❖ Sculptors | -Hunters |
| ❖ Blacksmiths | -Fishermen |
| ❖ Spirit mediums | -War captives [slaves] |

Other Madzimbabwe/ other stone building besides Great Zimbabwe.

- | | |
|-------------|---------|
| ❖ Naletale | -Khami |
| ❖ Munekwani | -Ruanga |
| ❖ Nhunguza | -Tsindi |
| ❖ Chipadze | |

The Decline of Great Zimbabwe State

Political reasons for the decline of Great Zimbabwe

1. Civil Wars

- There were civil wars in the state, for example, between Nyatsimba Mutota and Chagwa [1450] leading to Mutota's migration and formed his own state hence the decline of Great Zimbabwe state.

1. Succession disputes.

- There were some succession disputes in the Great Zimbabwe state which led to the decline of the Great Zimbabwe state in the sense that there was no longer peace in the state which made people to move out.

3. The vastness of the empire.

- The Great Zimbabwe state became too big to be ruled by one ruler and this brought disorder within the state forcing some people to break away from the state.

4. The rise of new states.

- The rise of new states like Torwa and Mutapa led to the decline of Great Zimbabwe state in the sense that people began to move out of the Great Zimbabwe state and settle in these newly created states.

5. Disunity in the state.

- Corruption and disunity in the ruling class led to the decline of the Great Zimbabwe state as it made people ready to move out and settle in other states such as Mutapa where there was no corruption.

6. The rise of ambitious leaders.

- There was emergence of ambitious people in the royal family like Nyatsimba Mutota who also wanted to establish their own states hence he broke out of the Mutapa state and created his own state.

7. Attacks by foreign groups.

- Wars and attacks from the Sotho and Tswana to the South West of Great Zimbabwe led to its decline because these attacks weakened the Great Zimbabwe state.

8. Weaknesses of the Dande people.

- The Dande region was occupied by weak people such as the Tonga, Tavara and the Korekore and this made it easier for Mutota to create his state and people from Great Zimbabwe began to occupy the Dande area.

Economic reasons for the decline of Great Zimbabwe

1. Decline in trade.

- Decline in trade led to the decline of Great Zimbabwe state in the sense that people no longer had some trade items such as ivory and minerals which forced them to move out of the state in search of these trade items.

2. Shortage of salt.

- There was shortage of resources like salt in the Great Zimbabwe state which forced the Prince, Nyatsimba Mutota and his followers to move out of the Great Zimbabwe state and formed the Mutapa state.

3. Exhaustion of fertile soil.

- There was exhaustion of soil fertility in the Great Zimbabwe state leading to poor harvests and this made people to move out of the state in search of fertile soil.

4. Exhaustion of minerals.

- Exhaustion of minerals such as gold, copper and iron at Great Zimbabwe led to its decline in the sense that it forced people to move out of the state looking for areas with minerals.

5. Exhaustion of wild animals.

- Exhaustion of wild animals for meat, skins and ivory led to the decline of Great Zimbabwe state since it made people to look for areas with wild animals.

6. Exhaustion of wild fruits.

- Wild fruits in the Great Zimbabwe state got exhausted due to a lot of people who were gathering and this forced people to move out and look for areas with a lot of wild fruits.

7. Drought

- There were poor harvests due to severe droughts in the Great Zimbabwe state which forced people to move out of the Great Zimbabwe state and settle in areas with high rainfall.

8. Over grazing.

- The Great Zimbabwe state also declined as a result of overgrazing which resulted in scarcity of grazing areas and this forced people to move out of the state and settle in the Dande area where there were a lot of grazing areas.

Social reasons for the decline of Great Zimbabwe

1. Overpopulation.

- There was overpopulation as a result of polygamy and rapid increase in population which resulted in shortage of land and other resources and this forced people to move out of the state.

2. Outbreak of diseases.

- There was spread of diseases such as typhoid and malaria which easily spread because of high population and this forced people to move out of the state.

3. Poor living standards.

- The Great Zimbabwe people were now living in poverty as a result of decline in trade and poor harvests and this made a lot of people to move out of the state.

4. The role of religion.

- The Great Zimbabwe people believed in the Hungwe bird and it is believed that this bird flew away from the Great Zimbabwe and went to the Dande area hence the people had also to follow in the Dande area.

5. Absence of peace.

- The Great Zimbabwe state was no longer as peaceful as it was before since there was now social instability in the state which led to its decline.

6. Plague of locust

- The plague of locusts also contributed to the decline of this state since the locusts attacked crops causing poor harvests and this forced people to move out.

Contribution of trade to the decline of Great Zimbabwe

- ❖ Trade led to the exhaustion of resources such as gold, ivory, ostrich feathers and the like.
- ❖ Trade with foreigners led to unfair trade practices which led to its collapse.
- ❖ They received worthless items like jewellery for gold and ivory.
- ❖ The opening of the Zambezi trade route [which favoured Mutapa] caused the decline of Great Zimbabwe.

Other factors which led to the decline of Great Zimbabwe

Exhaustion of pastures which made people to move out.

- ❖ Exhaustion of soil which made people to move out.
- ❖ Exhaustion of fire wood, game and other resources.
- ❖ Persistent droughts forced many people to move away.